

I Will Always Love You -- Dolly Parton

Dolly Parton, 1974. About 66 BPM, est.

This is Dolly's original country ballad, not the Whitney Houston version.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

The bass job is simple. Whole notes and half notes, root-fifth, with a few passing tones into the chord changes.

Warm and round. It should support the vocal and never get in its way.

Play it with your fingers over the neck. Solo the P pickup or lean on it heavily. Tone knob around 40%.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg115 IR (User IR 1)

The Ampeg B-15 flip-top was the standard studio bass amp of the 60s and early 70s. It's the right era and the right thump for a 1974 Nashville record.

Apg115 has a 100Hz peak that adds girth without mud. Classic Bass at low gain is the same Ampeg family, so it drives the B-15 cab cleanly.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 10. Barely there. Long notes must decay on their own.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 35, VOL: 58.

Light leveling so whole notes hold evenly through the bar. It doesn't flatten the dynamics.

DST -- off. No grit anywhere in this song.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 20, Bass: 60, Middle: 48, MidFreq: 450Hz, Treble: 38, VOL: 65.

Fully clean. Bass 60 is warm. Middle 48 at 450Hz takes a hair of boxiness off. Treble 38 rounds off finger noise.

CAB -- User IR 1 (Apg115), always on. VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +1, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: 0, 4.5kHz: -4, VOL: 52.

Low end fills the space under the acoustic guitars. The top rolls off hard for a vintage thump.

MOD -- off. DLY -- off.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 16, Decay: 30, Trail: on.

A small room so the bass blooms with the band on the choruses. Decay 30 stays short so the low end doesn't smear.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- Verses and the spoken section. Close, dry, and warm. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on** -- The "I will always love you" choruses. The room reverb opens the bass up into the same space as the rest of the band.

Engage it at each chorus. Step off for the verses.